

Figure 6.9 *Mosque remains, Dibul-Banbhore, Sindh, Pakistan. © Photograph Alka Patel 1997.*

as far west as Anatolia by the twelfth century, also had reverberations into coastal India: Throughout the tenth through twelfth centuries, various nomadic–pastoralist groups identified as Baluch were displaced from their encampments, pastures, and fields within the ambit of the Caspian Sea, thereby undertaking long-distance overland migrations into the eventually eponymous region of Baluchistan.[34] Thus, a historically more accurate idea of cosmopolitanism – at least as gleaned from this well-trafficked region of South Asia during the twelfth century – should encompass and ensue from the cultural expressions of *both* urban-centered elites as well as other groups along the nomad–urban continuum.

Architectural traces of the wide range of peoples, their economies and lifeways in Sindh and its contiguous areas reinforce the need for this inclusive notion of cosmopolitanism, to which Mu'izz al-Din and the Ghazna Shansabanis would have contributed as they forayed into the region. Modest single-room, brick-constructed but elegantly decorated funerary structures such as the tomb attributed to Muhammad ibn Harun at Lasbela (historical Armabil), generally dated to the eleventh century (Figure 6.10),[35] evince clear typological and formal dialogues with the virtually unstudied, probably earlier or contemporaneous funerary structures scattered throughout Baluchistan – for example, around Lasbela itself, Kharan, Kalat, Panjgur, and Jalawar. Abundant terracotta plaques with geometric and floral motifs, as well as figural scenes of agriculture and herding, clad almost the entirety of these structures' exterior surfaces.[36] Small-scale cultivation and animal husbandry were not only life-sustaining